

US–Iran Conflict Briefing

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Trump warns Xi over Chinese aid to Iran

- At the White House summit, President Trump told Xi Jinping that any direct or indirect Chinese help for Iran — intelligence, parts, military equipment — was "totally unacceptable," according to U.S. Ambassador to China David Perdue, speaking on CNBC Friday. Perdue said Beijing gave assurances Thursday it is not aiding Tehran. — [Reuters](#)
- Trump confirmed to reporters Friday that the two leaders discussed the Iran war. China's Xinhua said Xi urged both sides to return to the June framework and resume negotiations. — [Reuters](#)
- **CONTESTED** outcome: a senior Iranian official told Reuters Friday that Chinese officials assured Iran China will NOT limit its economic, political or military ties with Tehran. The U.S. and Iranian versions of what Beijing promised cannot both be true — lead with the less escalatory reading (Beijing's assurances to Washington) and treat the outcome as contested. — [Reuters](#)

Iraq grounds all Iranian flights

- Erbil and Sulaimaniya airports suspended Iranian flights starting Friday; Najaf International Airport halted all Iran flights effective 02:00 Friday until further notice, according to state media. Baghdad had been ordered shut from Wednesday. — [Reuters](#)
- Flights to and from Iran are now suspended at all four Iraqi airports that operated them. The move follows the U.S. Treasury warning that any firm servicing Iranian carriers faces sanctions and dollar-system exclusion — and comes a day after the UAE suspended all Iranian-airline flights. — [Reuters](#)

Araghchi details seven-day Hormuz plan; Tehran rules out nuclear concessions

- Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi publicly detailed Iran's seven-day plan outside the UN Security Council on Friday: "The seven-day timeline will start as soon as the United States accepts this plan" — initial steps take four to five days, the Strait of Hormuz opens on day six, and direct nuclear talks with the U.S. begin on day seven. — [Reuters](#)
- The plan, conveyed to Washington via Qatari mediators, requires the U.S. to lift its naval blockade of Iranian ports, waive oil sanctions, release frozen funds, and observe a ceasefire including Lebanon. The White House said Friday its officials are having "positive and constructive discussions through the mediators." Pezeshkian hosted Qatar's prime minister early Friday. — [Reuters](#)
- **Hard limit:** a senior Iranian official told Reuters Friday that even if Washington accepts the plan, Iran will offer NO nuclear concessions — no giving up enrichment rights, no shipping highly enriched uranium out of the country. — [Reuters](#)

Houthi escalation around Saudi Arabia; France deploys air defenses to Yanbu

- **REPORTED BUT UNCONFIRMED** (high-impact claim, no Saudi confirmation): Houthi military spokesman Yahya Saree claimed Sept 25 that the Houthis fired ballistic and cruise missiles plus drones at the Saudi Aramco refinery in Yanbu and an unspecified target in Riyadh. — [TBS News](#)

- Less-escalatory verified baseline: Saudi air defenses intercepted six Houthi ballistic missiles aimed at Taif and the Yanbu area on Thursday. Launches are outlet-verified; impact claims are contested — state both sides. — [TBS News](#)
- France will send soldiers, radar platforms and air-defense systems to protect the Yanbu oil terminal, President Emmanuel Macron said Thursday — strictly defensive, not joining the fight. No timetable disclosed. Yanbu's East-West Pipeline is Saudi Arabia's main Hormuz-bypass export artery; a Houthi attack damaged the Yasref refinery in the area last week. — [WSJ](#)
- Macron called a possible U.S. ban on diesel exports "catastrophic," both globally and for the U.S. economy — a rare direct French intervention in the American sanctions debate. — [WSJ](#)
- Iranian escalation-adjacent rhetoric: Deputy Foreign Minister Gharibabadi posted on X Thursday evening, after NATO's chief acknowledged roughly 5,000 U.S. sorties from European bases, that governments which "placed their territory at the disposal of the United States cannot evade their responsibility" — "this participation will not go unanswered." — [Press TV](#)

Iranian officials warn over aviation sanctions and European bases

- Iran's Supreme National Security Council secretary Mohsen Rezaei said on state television Sept 24: the U.S. has "four or five days" to meet Tehran's seven conditions — otherwise "we will neither open the Strait of Hormuz nor is there any negotiation on the table." He threatened neighbors cooperating with the Iranian aviation sanctions: "their airports won't be able to have flights either." — [IRINN](#) ([Iranian state TV](#))
- Pezeshkian, in an interview aired Thursday on Fox News' "Special Report with Bret Baier," said it is up to the United States to choose when the war ends: "But we do not wish to continue. It's America that must choose whether it wants to end this or not." — [Reuters](#)

Cape Dao update: union says two torpedoes; victim named

- New details on the Sept 23 attack (covered in the Sept 23 evening edition): India's Forward Seamen's Union says the MV Cape Dao was hit by TWO torpedoes on its port side — one at the C-deck accommodation, one near the engine room. The union's torpedo claim is unproven; the maritime authority's original report said "unknown projectile." — [India Seatrade News](#)
- The seafarer killed was named: wiper Suraj Yadav, 26, of Deoria, Uttar Pradesh, who died of head injuries. India's External Affairs Ministry condemned the attack; 19 of the 20 Indian seafarers were rescued and 27 of 28 crew were evacuated by the Royal Navy of Oman. The Antigua and Barbuda-flagged bulker was sailing Mina Saqr to India, attacked ~2.5 nautical miles off Musandam. — [India Seatrade News](#)
- Attribution remains contested: no party has claimed responsibility and no outlet attributes the attack. One British analyst rates Iranian responsibility as "likely" at moderate confidence. The vessel was reportedly not on Iran's non-compliant vessel list. — [India Seatrade News](#)

Markets

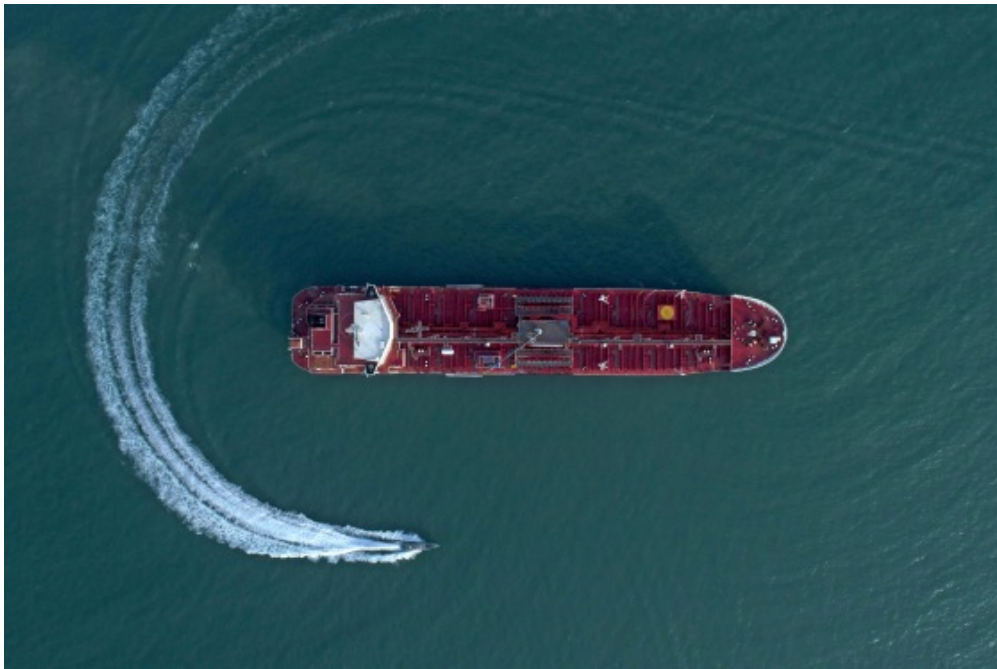
- Brent settled at \$104.32/bbl on Sept 25, down 2.1% on the day (up 0.4% on the week), as diplomacy hopes offset Thursday's surge. — [WSJ](#)

- WTI settled at \$92.41/bbl on Sept 25, down 2.3% on the day. — [WSJ](#)

Related media



Trump and Xi at the White House summit, where Trump pressed China over aid to Iran (Reuters photo) — [view original](#)



Oil tanker in the Strait of Hormuz — [view original](#)



Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi — [view original](#)

- [CNN International: Iran offers new proposal to restart U.S. talks and reopen Hormuz](#)
- [Abbas Araghchi proposes seven-day Hormuz roadmap as Iran pushes to end war](#)

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